

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

NOISE AND HEARING CONSERVATION

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Measure and reduce noise at source where feasible, preventing hearing loss through engineering controls, exposure-time management and correct hearing protection.

KEY HAZARDS

1



HIGH NOISE

2



IMPACT NOISE

3



LONG EXPOSURE

4



POOR PLUG FIT

5



LOST COMMUNICATION

6



MISSED ALARM

7



DAMAGED PROTECTOR

8



HEARING LOSS

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

85 dBA

8-hour TWA hearing-conservation action level

90 dBA

8-hour TWA permissible exposure

Annual

Audiogram for covered employees



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

# NOISE AND HEARING CONSERVATION

## STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA 1910.95 addresses monitoring, engineering/administrative controls, hearing conservation, audiometry, protector selection and training.

### OSHA 1910.95(b) EXPOSURE CONTROL

Use feasible engineering or administrative controls above permissible exposure levels.

### OSHA 1910.95(d) MONITORING

Conduct representative personal or area monitoring where 85 dBA 8-hour TWA may be reached, and repeat after change.

### OSHA 1910.95(g) AUDIOMETRY

Provide baseline and annual audiograms to covered employees and evaluate significant shifts.

### OSHA 1910.95(i) HEARING PROTECTORS

Offer suitable choices, train correct fitting and verify effective field attenuation.

## MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- |                                                   |                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Noise-survey map         | <input type="checkbox"/> Personal dosimetry record                     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Engineering-control plan | <input type="checkbox"/> Protector selection / attenuation calculation |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Audiometry program       | <input type="checkbox"/> Training record                               |

## SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- What is today's measured level?
- How can we reduce the source?
- How is the protector fitted correctly?

## NOISE MONITORING AND CORRECT PROTECTOR FIT



Monitoring - Source control - Zone - Correct fit - Audiometry

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. ELIMINATE NOISY WORK

Select quieter equipment and methods; consider noise data during procurement.

2. ISOLATE THE SOURCE

Use silencers, enclosures, barriers, maintenance and vibration isolation.

3. CONTROL TIME AND AREA

Reduce exposure time, control the zone and preserve alarms and communication.

4. FIT CORRECT PROTECTION

Fit plugs or muffs correctly; use dual protection and fit verification where required.

CRITICAL WARNING



Ringings ears or temporary post-shift hearing reduction is an early warning. Report exposure; do not rely on PPE alone.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- ☐ Noise survey current

☐ Zone controlled

☐ Protector correctly selected

☐ Earmuffs intact

☐ Team briefed
- ☐ Source controls working

☐ Exposure time planned

☐ Earplug correctly fitted

☐ Alarm remains audible

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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site:

Date:

Presented by:

Work area:

| No | Full Name | Company / Role | Signature |
|----|-----------|----------------|-----------|
| 1  |           |                |           |
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| 12 |           |                |           |